

FLOWERS AND THEIR POLLINATORS



Honey hunters

As it feasts on nectar, the Australian honey possum gets pollen on its fur.

Most plants cannot make seeds without some outside help. The first job is to move pollen from the anther of one flower to the stigma of another. This is called pollination. Plants cannot travel, but their flowers produce sweet nectar, which animals love. As the animal feeds on the nectar, some pollen rubs onto its body. Each time it moves on to another flower, it leaves some pollen behind and picks up a new supply.



This bee is having a good pollen bath.

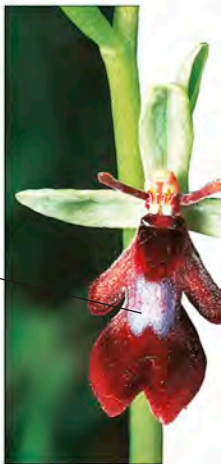
Pollen stop

Bees flit from flower to flower all day, feeding on nectar. Each time they stop, they pick up some pollen.

A flower, not a fly!

Clever tricks

Fly orchids look and smell like the real thing. Male flies looking for a mate are easily tricked. They buzz off in disgust, taking the orchid's pollen with them.



Pollen from the anthers of the flower sticks to the butterfly's body.



Nectar gatherers

Brightly colored flowers attract butterflies looking for nectar.

Pollen galore

Some plants rely on the wind to carry pollen between flowers. These catkins, for example, produce masses of pollen to make sure some will end up reaching the tiny stigmas of its female counterparts.

